

SENATE RESOLUTION 294

By Gardenhire

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the Legacy: Lifted By God and Led By Love and the retirement of Robert Gardenhire.

WHEREAS, it is proper that the members of this legislative body recognize those citizens that sacrifice themselves to honor God and family; and

WHEREAS, Robert Gardenhire became a member of the Schrader Lane Church of Christ in 1974 and in 1984, after thirty-one years, was appointed Assistant Minister to Dr. David Jones III (Senior Minister); and

WHEREAS, during his forty-one-year tenure, he taught Bible classes, conducted personal Bible studies, provided ministerial counseling and premarital counseling, and conducted numerous weddings and funerals; and

WHEREAS, during his forty-one-year tenure, Robert Gardenhire traveled to North Carolina and Nigeria, West Africa on several missionary journeys. He also preached and evangelized holding Gospel meetings in numerous churches in the United States, conducting sessions at state lectureships and other local, state, and national gatherings; and

WHEREAS, during his ten-year tenure as Senior Minister, he ordained eleven formal leaders of the congregations as elders and deacons. As Senior Minister, he mentored, encouraged, taught, and trained young men to preach and teach in various capacities and provided them opportunities to practice their craft in serving the congregation in various capacities and settings; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure, he authored a book entitled *Essentials of Project Funding: A Practical Guide For Managing the Process*, and he conducted debt-retirement workshops at several Churches of Christ across the country as well as at other nonprofit organizations; and

WHEREAS, Robert Gardenhire continues to serve in various capacities as the Senior Minister Emeritus, where he continues to be Lifted by God and Led by Love in ALL that he does for the Glory of God; and

WHEREAS, Robert Gardenhire was born on January 13, 1952, to Charles W. and Kirkalene Savage Gardenhire in Putnam County, humble beginnings, where he was taught a love for God and mankind and the value of hard work and service to all people; and

WHEREAS, Robert Gardenhire graduated from Tennessee Technological University with a Bachelor of Science degree in Business Administration; and

WHEREAS, in 1977, Robert Gardenhire married Vanessa Thompson Gardenhire. They have two daughters, Angela (Eric) and Andrea (Dwayne); one adult son, Auston; and one grandson, Lan (parents Angela and Eric); and

WHEREAS, in his professional career, Robert Gardenhire was employed with Bridgestone/Firestone from June 1974 until June 2015 (forty-one years). He held positions from Plant Transportation Analyst to General Manager of Transportation to Director of Logistics and resident of Fleet Operations from 2012 until 2015, when he retired; and

WHEREAS, Robert Gardenhire has excelled in civic and nonprofit affiliations and boards; he has served on the Davidson County Port Authority, St. Thomas Hospital Board of Ethics, and the Tennessee Technological University College of Business Advisory Board; and

WHEREAS, he currently serves on these prestigious boards: the Tennessee Technological University College of Business Foundation, Schrader Acres Senior Living Center Executive Board of Directors, and the United Way of Greater Nashville Board of Directors; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and declare February 21, 2026, as "Robert Gardenhire Day" for his service to his God, Family, and Community.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.